

GOOGLE PLAY CONSOLE PUBLISHING & VERIFICATION GUIDE

Detailed Account Requirements and Console Steps to Launch the LawOnCall App

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Target Platform	Google Play Store (Production)	Status	Release-Ready

1. Developer Account Registration Options

To publish apps on the Google Play Store, you must register a developer account. Google offers two account types: **Personal Account** (for solo developers) and **Organization/Business Account** (for businesses, startups, and law firms). Below is the exact list of requirements for both.

Requirement	Personal Developer Account	Organization / Business Account
Ideal For	Individuals, freelance developers.	Registered businesses, LLPs, Corporations, Firms.
Registration Cost	\$25 USD (One-time fee)	\$25 USD (One-time fee)
D-U-N-S Number	Not required.	Mandatory (9-digit Dun & Bradstreet ID).
Verification Documents	Personal government-issued photo ID.	Business Registration Certificate + Authorized Representative ID.
Website & Domain	Not required.	Mandatory (Must match corporate business domain).

2. Document Verification Checklist

Gather the following documents before proceeding with your registration to ensure immediate Google approval:

2.1. For Personal Developer Accounts

- **Personal Government-Issued Photo ID:** Must contain your full legal name, date of birth, and expiration date.
 - ****Accepted IDs (India):**** Passport, Driving License, Voter ID card, or PAN Card (Aadhaar cards are currently NOT accepted by Google).
- **Contact Phone & Email:** Must be active to receive verification codes (OTPs) during sign-up.
- **International Payment Card:** A credit or debit card with international transactions enabled for the \$25 registration fee.

2.2. For Organization / Business Accounts (Recommended for LawOnCall)

- **D-U-N-S Number (Data Universal Numbering System):** A unique 9-digit business identifier.
 - You can request one for free on the Dun & Bradstreet website. The setup takes 5–10 business days.
 - The legal name and address used on Google Play Console must match the D-U-N-S records exactly.
- **Official Business Registration Document:**
 - ****Accepted Documents:**** Certificate of Incorporation (COI), GST Certificate, Shop & Establishment license, Partnership Deed, or corporate Tax identification letters.
- **Corporate Email & Website Domain:** An official email matching your corporate domain (e.g., admin@lawoncall.in). Generic Gmail addresses are not accepted for organization accounts.
- **Authorized Representative Legal ID:** A government-issued photo ID (Passport/PAN Card) of the designated person creating the developer profile on behalf of the company.

3. Step-by-Step Account Creation & Fee Payment

1. Go to the [Google Play Console Registration] (<https://play.google.com/console/signup>).
2. Log in using the primary Google account designated for your company.
3. Choose your account type: **Organization** or **Personal**.
4. Fill out the developer registration form:
 - For Organizations: Enter your legal business name, D-U-N-S number, corporate address, website, and phone.
 - For Persons: Enter your legal name, home address, contact phone, and email.
5. Pay the **\$25 USD (one-time fee)** on the payment screen.
6. Once payment is complete, upload the requested identity and business registration documents when prompted. Google will review and verify your identity within 2 to 5 business days.

4. Uploading the App Package and Publishing

Once your Developer Account is active, follow these steps to upload your compiled **app-release.aab** package:

4.1. Declare Payment Policies (Razorpay & PhonePe)

 **Payment Policy Declaration:** Because LawOnCall provides professional consultation services delivered by human lawyers over the phone, it is exempt from the Google Play In-App Billing requirement. You do not need to pay Google 15–30% on transaction commissions. When completing the financial declaration questionnaire, select **"Real-World / Professional Services"** to allow custom gateway payments (Razorpay/PhonePe).

4.2. Complete App Content Surveys

Complete the following mandatory tasks on the Play Console App Dashboard:

- **Privacy Policy:** Add a link to your website's privacy policy (e.g., <https://lawoncall.in/privacy-policy>).
- **Target Audience:** Select **18 and over** (appropriate for legal consults).
- **Content Rating:** Complete the survey to get a rating for your app (select "Utility/Productivity").

- **Data Safety:** Declare that your app collects User Name, Email, and Phone Number for account creation, and that all data is encrypted in transit (HTTPS).

4.3. Store Listing Setup

Go to **Grow users** -> **Store presence** -> **Main store listing**:

- **App Icon:** Upload your `512x512 px` PNG file.
- **Feature Graphic:** Upload your `1024x500 px` PNG feature image.
- **Screenshots:** Upload at least 2–4 screenshots of your app running on phone and tablet ratios.

4.4. Production Release

1. Navigate to **Release** -> **Production** on the left menu.
2. Click **Create new release**.
3. Upload the **app-release.aab** file you generated.
4. Write a short release note (e.g., Initial launch of LawOnCall PWA.).
5. Click **Save** -> **Review release** -> **Start rollout to Production**!

 **Policy Review Phase:** Your app status will become **"In review"**. Google's policy team will review your app code and verify your digital asset links (`assetlinks.json`). This approval process typically takes between **2 to 7 business days** before the app goes live on the store.